

Buckeye Experimental Aeronautics

Student Organization Constitution

ARTICLE I. NAME OF ORGANIZATION

The name of this organization shall be Buckeye Experimental Aeronautics, abbreviated as BExA.

ARTICLE II. ORGANIZATION PURPOSE

Buckeye Experimental Aeronautics exists to design, analyze, manufacture, test, and operate experimental high-performance unmanned aircraft systems while advancing the educational mission of The Ohio State University.

The organization provides students with practical experience in aerospace engineering disciplines including design, structures, aerodynamics, propulsion, avionics, systems integration, testing, and regulatory compliance. BExA emphasizes technical competence, responsible experimentation, and adherence to applicable safety standards and FAA regulations.

Through participation in the organization's activities, members develop engineering judgement, documentation practices, collaboration skills, and leadership experience consistent with professional expectations in the aerospace field. The organization supports experiential learning and interdisciplinary engagement within the University community.

ARTICLE III. UNIVERSITY REGULATIONS

Section A. Harassment and Discrimination, including Sexual Misconduct

Buckeye Experimental Aeronautics agrees that it will not engage in sexual misconduct nor any harassment or discrimination on the basis of age, ancestry, color, disability, gender identity or expression, genetic information, HIV/AIDS status, military status, national origin, race, religion, sex, sexual orientation, protected veteran status or any other basis in accordance with these guidelines.

Section B. Hazing

Buckeye Experimental Aeronautics agrees to maintain a zero-tolerance policy for hazing, in compliance with Ohio State University and Collin's Law. All members must conduct themselves in a manner that supports an environment free from hazing. Hazing includes any activity, regardless of consent, that causes or creates a substantial risk of physical, mental, or emotional harm or humiliation to any individual as part of membership or affiliation with the student organization. If found responsible for hazing, members and/or the organization may face disciplinary actions.

Section C. Bylaws

Buckeye Experimental Aeronautics retains the right to maintain separate bylaws to outline the day-to-day operations of the organization and to clarify policies and procedures otherwise not included in these constitutional articles. Bylaws and/or other guiding documents may not take precedence over the requirements set forth by local, state, and federal laws, The Ohio State University's regulations, policies, and procedures, and the Council on Student Affairs Student Organization Registration Guidelines. Organizations may make amendments and changes to the bylaws without consulting the Ohio Union & Student Activities Department, and changes to bylaws do not require approval. All elements of organizational bylaws shall be consistent with the organization's currently approved constitution on file and CSA constitution requirements

ARTICLE IV. MEMBERSHIP

Section A. Membership Eligibility

Membership is open to all currently enrolled students at The Ohio State University. Other groups including faculty, staff, alumni, and partners of students may participate as associate members but may not exceed 10% of total membership and may not vote.

Membership shall not be restricted on the basis of any protected class identified in Article III.

Section B. Member Selection

Students become members by enrolling in the organization's official external communication platform, completing required onboarding and safety training, and paying dues if applicable. Additional participation requirements, including eligibility for leadership roles or technical access, shall be defined in the bylaws.

Section C. Membership Timeline

Membership is open on a rolling basis throughout the academic year. Specific onboarding periods, training requirements, and dues timelines are defined in the bylaws.

Section D. Member Removal

A member may be subject to removal if the member violates University policy, FAA regulations, team safety standards, anti-hazing provisions, or engages in serious misconduct including sabotage, misappropriation of funds, embezzlement of team resources, or actions that materially endanger the organization's operations or reputation.

Removal requires written notice of the allegations, an opportunity for the member to respond before the Executive Board, and subsequent deliberation. Final removal requires a two-thirds (2/3) vote of active leadership members. The Primary Advisor shall be consulted prior to final action.

ARTICLE V. ADVISOR

Section A. Advisor Duties and Responsibilities

The organization shall maintain a Primary Advisor who is a faculty or administrative/professional staff member at The Ohio State University. The Advisor serves as a mentor and institutional resource, supports compliance with University policies, completes required advisor training and anti-hazing certification, approves annual registration and funding submissions as required, and may provide guidance during office transitions. The Advisor does not vote and may not hold office within the organization.

Section B. Advisor Term

The Advisor shall serve a renewable one-year term.

Section C. Advisor Selection

The Primary Advisor must be a faculty or administrative/professional staff member at The Ohio State University. They shall be nominated by the Executive Board and confirmed by a majority vote of active leadership members

Section D. Advisor Replacement

In the event of a resignation or removal of the Advisor, the Executive Board shall nominate a replacement. Confirmation of the new Advisor requires a majority vote of active leadership members. Registration materials shall be updated accordingly.

ARTICLE VI. ORGANIZATION LEADERSHIP

Section A. Officer Positions

Buckeye Experimental Aeronautics shall be governed by an Executive Board. At minimum, the organization shall maintain the offices of President (Primary Leader) and Business Director (Treasurer).

In addition, the organization shall maintain either a Vice President or a Technical Director to fulfill the role of Secondary Leader as required by University guidelines. Both positions may exist simultaneously; however, at least one must be filled at all times.

The Vice President assists the President in coordinating organizational operations and internal administration. The Technical Director oversees the technical direction of the organization's engineering activities and review processes.

If both positions are filled, the Executive Board shall designate which individual serves as the official Secondary Leader for University registration and compliance purposes. This designation shall be confirmed by a majority vote of active leadership members as defined in the bylaws.

Section B. Officer Eligibility

Officers must be full members in good standing, maintain academic eligibility under University standards, and comply with articles III and IV of this constitution. The President and Treasurer must be enrolled as full-time students. The Vice President must be a student in good standing.

Section C. Officer Selection Process

Elections shall occur during the spring semester. Candidates for President shall formally accept nomination and present their qualifications along with a proposed Executive Board structure. The Executive Board shall be elected by secret ballot and requires a majority vote of active leadership members. If no candidate or slate receives a majority, a runoff election between the top two shall be conducted. Newly elected officers shall assume office at the conclusion of the academic year or at a transition point defined in the bylaws.

Section D. Officer Removal and Vacancies.

Officers may be removed for failure to fulfill responsibilities, misconduct, safety violations, violation of University policy, or loss of eligibility. Removal requires written notice of the allegations, an opportunity for the officer to respond before the Executive Board and Advisor, and a two-thirds (2/3) vote of active leadership members.

In the event of resignation or vacancy, a special election shall be held within a reasonable timeframe. Interim appointments may be made by majority vote of active leadership members until the special election is conducted.

ARTICLE VII. ORGANIZATION DISSOLUTION

Section A. Dissolution Requirements

Dissolution of Buckeye Experimental Aeronautics requires a two-thirds (2/3) vote of active leadership members and consultation with the Advisor.

Section B. Dissolution Procedures

Upon dissolution, all outstanding debts must be satisfied. Remaining assets shall be transferred to The Ohio State University or to another registered engineering student organization with a similar purpose. Under no circumstances may debts be left to the University.

ARTICLE VIII. CONSTITUTIONAL AMENDMENTS

Amendments may be proposed by any Executive Board member or by petition of at least twenty percent (20%) of active leadership members. Proposed amendments must be distributed in writing and remain open for discussion for at least one week before a vote. Adoption requires a two-thirds (2/3) vote of active leadership members. Approved amendments must be submitted to Ohio Union & Student Activities within thirty (30) days.]